

Team 4 – Deliverable 4: Heuristic Evaluation (Part B)

Summary

This document covers the feedback we got from Teams 8 and 9 during the heuristic evaluation of our prototype. Each team pointed out areas where our design could be improved, based on usability principles. For every issue they found, we gave it a severity rating and decided if we're going to fix it or not. In some cases, we explained why we won't make a change, usually because it didn't line up with our goals or the feature wasn't part of our app to begin with. Overall, their feedback was really helpful and gave us a better idea of what's working and what needs improvement.

Issues Identified by Team 8

(Collected by Jonathan + Severity Ratings by Stanley)

Issue 1: Unable to delete one's tasks

Heuristic Violated: User control and freedom

Description: When you go to North Texas Food Bank, and once you invite your friends, you cannot message them as it doesn't show how that option functions.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: No

Reason: We don't think it is necessary to have a message option once the user invites friends, but more that the friends of the user can message when they accept the invite on the group that is created as seen in the picture.

Issue 2: About section is too long and has small text

Heuristic Violated: Aesthetic and minimalist design

Description: The about section for the North Texas Food Bank is too long and also has small text that would be hard to read from a phone screen. The user would likely not read this long of text and also would struggle to do so. The font that says "About" is even smaller than the paragraph itself.

Severity: 1

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We should keep font size consistent for the users to be able to read.

Issue 3: Text on welcome page matches with background in areas

Heuristic Violated: Aesthetic and minimalist design

Description: The text in the welcome page saying “Find a way to help. Discover opportunities that match your passions” is in white, which matches the floor in the background picture. This makes it harder to read for the user.

Severity: 1

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: Some users may find it a bit difficult to read the text in the leftmost section, so the color of the text can be adjusted accordingly.

Issue 4: Ambiguous bottom navigation icons

Heuristic Violated: Recognition rather than recall

Description: The bottom navigation bar uses the same star icon for both the “Opportunities” and “Messages” tabs. Users cannot rely on icons alone to distinguish these tabs and must read the labels every time, which slows down navigation and increases cognitive effort. Assigning a unique and meaningful icon to each tab would allow users to recognize their desired tab at a glance.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: A simple change in the design of the icons may help users to navigate through the application a bit easier.

Issue 5: Lack of searchable list for cause selection

Heuristic Violated: Flexibility and efficiency of use

Description: The “What causes do you care about?” section displays only a few causes without an option to search or select from a list. This limits the user’s ability to find and choose causes that they care about, especially if their interests aren’t in the few causes given. Adding a dropdown or searchable list would improve usability.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: No

Reason: The design we had for “What causes do you care about?” allows for the user to select one or more causes that they are interested in, which they can then proceed with. Adding a dropdown would not seem to improve usability.

Issue 6: No feedback after inviting friends

Heuristic Violated: Visibility of system status

Description: When a user taps to invite friends (e.g., Leo, Kayla), the interface does not display any confirmation or status indicator that the invitation was sent successfully. Without visual or textual feedback (e.g., a checkmark, message, or toast notification), users might repeatedly tap or be unsure if the action worked.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: Adding a screen that confirms that an invite has been sent will be helpful for the user to know that their invite was sent successfully.

Issues Identified by Team 9

(Collected by Joshua + Severity Ratings by Jaden)

Issue 1: No clear indication that "Add to my itinerary" was successful

Heuristic Violated: Visibility of system status

Description: When a user taps "Add to my itinerary," there is no feedback (animation, color change, or confirmation) showing the action was completed. This could lead to user uncertainty and repeated or abandoned actions.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: It can be extremely frustrating not knowing whether the change you made took place or not.

Issue 2: Navigation icons lack text labels

Heuristic Violated: Recognition rather than recall

Description: The bottom navigation bar only displays icons (e.g., Opportunities, Home, Messages) without textual labels. This increases cognitive load for new users who must remember what each icon means.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We don't want new users to have to struggle to navigate our app.

Issue 3: "Join!" button does not clarify next steps

Heuristic Violated: Match between system and the real world

Description: The button does not explain what "joining" means (volunteering, donating, etc.), which may cause hesitation or confusion.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: No

Reason: We don't have this button to begin with.

Issue 4: Inviting friends lacks confirmation or progress feedback

Heuristic Violated: User control and freedom

Description: There is no feedback or undo option when inviting friends, which prevents users from correcting mistakes or confirming action success.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We want users to know when their actions are successful.

Issue 5: No error prevention for accidentally leaving a page

Heuristic Violated: Error prevention

Description: Users may leave a page unintentionally by tapping navigation icons, losing progress if the app does not save state.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We don't want users to be frustrated because they lose progress over an accidental misclick.

Issue 6: Overly detailed About section reduces scannability

Heuristic Violated: Aesthetic and minimalist design

Description: The About section is text-heavy, making it hard for users to quickly find key information like "How to help" or "Volunteer steps."

Severity: 1

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We want the content in the About section to be clean and scannable, especially on small screens.

Issue 7: No clear recovery instructions for failed actions

Heuristic Violated: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

Description: If an action like joining or inviting fails due to a network error, users receive no notification or recovery guidance.

Severity: 3

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We want to make sure that users are able to use our app to effectively accomplish what they downloaded it for.

Issue 8: No in-app help or tutorial

Heuristic Violated: Help and documentation

Description: The app lacks onboarding or help features for core actions like adding to itinerary or inviting friends.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: It's important that we show our users how to use core functions of the app.

Issue 9: No shortcuts for frequent users

Heuristic Violated: Flexibility and efficiency of use

Description: Power users cannot save favorites or revisit recent activity efficiently.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: Users should be able to have ease of access to their favorites, and see their past history in the app.

Issue 10: Inconsistent use of icons for interaction

Heuristic Violated: Consistency and standards

Description: The heart icon appears on the home screen for favoriting but is absent from the detail screen, potentially confusing users about how to save items.

Severity: 2

Will Fix?: Yes

Reason: We want our app to be consistent with what we offer.

Contributors

- **Jonathan Gonzalez** – Collected issues from Team 8 feedback
- **Joshua Gambrell** – Collected issues from Team 9 feedback
- **Stanley Gerzim** – Assigned severity ratings and fix decisions for each Team 8 issue
- **Jaden Flores** – Assigned severity ratings and fix decisions for each Team 9 issue
- **Hector Gonzalez** – Final review, formatting, summary, and submission (Coordinator)